Travel Agents: Taiwan — Rules

Rival travel agencies chase the same food stalls through one eating day. Ride between four regions, gather ingredients, and pile Followers on the stalls you want: win a stall by drawing the biggest crowd and it joins your tour, making the next one cheaper. Your only points are the Bookings you run — complete the most before the last train to be Top Agent.

🖼 FIG · SETUP

illustration reserved — see art brief

These are real Taiwanese dishes and night markets — celebrated with care. Eat them with a grin.

3–6 players · 30–45 min

1. What you're going for

Your score is your Bookings, and nothing else. A Booking is a little tour you promise to run — three breakfast stalls, a ★ marquee name. Complete it to score its value; leave it unfinished and it costs you. Vendors and Followers never score. Most Booking points at the last train is Top Agent (§9).

2. Setup

> 🖼 [FIG-SETUP] — the shared board with its callouts.

Everything sits on one shared board, readable from any seat. Everyone starts in Taipei (North).

- The map — four regions in a ring: North 北 · Central 中 · South 南 · East 東. Ring-neighbours are linked; the HSR also links North and South directly.
- Ingredient markets — each region has a face-down market deck. Split each into DAY and NIGHT piles; shuffle the DAY into place, set the NIGHT aside for dusk.
- Vendor stalls — fill the face-up slots from each region's DAY vendor deck (counts below); set the NIGHT vendor decks aside for dusk.
- Booking decks — at 3 players, first set aside the seven tours marked 4–6 (they need more stalls than a 3-player game supplies). Shuffle the rest into the 開團 tour supply: the ⟳ any-time tours can be booked from the start and worked on all game, while the ☀ day tours come out by day and the ☾ night tours at night (see the setup chart for sizes). The decks are your tour supply, not the clock (the clock is the vendors, §8). Deal a face-up Booking row to start.
- Followers — take your full pool in your colour (6; the Influencer 網紅 owns 8): put 2 on your board, the rest in your own supply.

- Each player takes a character board (read its ability and flaw aloud), a pawn in Taipei, an empty Larder face-up, and their COMPLETED 成團 and CANCELLED 取消 pile markers.

The setup chart on the board gives, for your count, the vendor slots per region and the Booking-deck sizes. There are deliberately fewer stalls than agents — so you'll collide over them. First player is whoever ate street food most recently, then clockwise; the Influencer 網紅 takes the last seat.

3. Your turn

Take ONE action. Then, if your Larder holds more than 7 ingredients, discard down to 7.

- VISIT the market (where you stand) — flip the top 3 of this region's market. Any event fires now (§7), then discards. Keep 2 ingredients (the Big Eater 大胃王 keeps 3).
- CONVENIENCE STORE (anywhere) — flip the top 1 of any market: take the ingredient, or its event fires.
- TRAVEL — move to a neighbour (or North↔South by HSR), then flip the top 1 where you arrive (an event on arrival does nothing). Then grow your crowd: 1 follower, supply → your board.
- PROMOTE (with a vendor here) — place up to 2 followers from your board onto stall(s) here, stacked or spread (§4).
- BRIBE a vendor (with it) — win a stall you've drawn the biggest crowd for (§5).
- BOOK a tour — take a Booking into your hand (§6).

> **Greedy Grab.** On a Visit or Convenience Store, keep one extra ingredient beyond your limit — send 1 follower back to your supply (the crowd tuts and drifts).
>
> **Characters bend the rules.** Each board has one ability and one flaw for that player alone; where a board disagrees with these rules, the board wins. Some agents are flaw-free by design.

4. Followers — your crowd

Followers are the hype you pile on a stall — never in hand, always in full view. Each is in one of three places: your supply (un-rallied), your board (rallied), or on a stall (committed). You own a fixed pool in your colour — 6, or 8 for the Influencer 網紅 — and can never commit more than you own. They flow supply → board (grow, on Travel) → stall (Promote), then home to your board on a win or back to your own supply on a loss (§5).

5. Bribing a vendor — the biggest crowd wins

A face-up vendor goes to whoever draws the biggest crowd for it. To Bribe a vendor you stand with:

1. hold strictly more of your followers on it than any single rival — an outright plurality (a tie claims nothing; the Big Brother 大哥 alone wins by matching);
2. pay its ingredients, minus your region discounts (the crowd decides only who pays — there is no follower cost).

Take it onto your tour and complete any Booking it satisfies (§6). Your followers come home to your board; each loser's scatter to their own supply (the crowd drifts to the rival's stall, never onto it) — the whole cost of losing. Leave the slot empty for now.

A tie just blocks. Level for the lead (no Big Brother present)? None may claim; the crowds ride — Promote again to break it, or walk away and leave them.

Stalls are scarce and refill slowly. A claimed or emptied slot stays empty; all empty slots refill only at the end of the round (and a stall that no one queues at eventually sells out, §8). So a stall may be the region's only one — out-commit a rival, or Travel on and risk it being gone.

A won vendor is pure engine. Most show a region icon: each icon you hold makes that region's ingredients 1 cheaper to Bribe — your ramp. Drinks and ★ apex stalls carry no icon. Night stalls cost more and often want two regions' ingredients.

> Trending 爆紅. An event can drop a Trending marker on a stall; win it and your crowd grows +1 — it went viral. The printed ★ apex stalls are a separate, permanent thing — a region's top table.
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> Rave Reviews 好評. The first time you complete your 2nd tour, grow your crowd +1; at your 4th, take 1 ingredient of choice and your next Bribe costs 1 less. Once each, per player.

6. Bookings — your tours

A Booking (開團) is a tour you line up to run. Hold at most 3. There are three kinds, told apart on the card:

- ⟳ any-time (most tours) — finish it any time before the last train; it never cancels at dusk. The safe, default line.
- ☀ day — must be finished before dusk or it's cancelled. Riskier, so it pays a little more.
- ☾ night — a night target, finished by the last train.

Book a tour is one action, taken ONE of two ways:

- from the row — take one card from the face-up Booking row into your hand, then refill the row; or
- Pot-Luck (隨緣開團) — decline the whole row and draw the top card of the current Booking deck blind (the DAY deck by day, the NIGHT deck at night), taking it into your hand. You keep it (you don't see it first), and the row is not refilled.

One Book = one tour, one way or the other — never both. Use Pot-Luck when nothing in the row suits you: you are never stuck with no tour worth booking.

- Complete it (成團). The moment your won vendors satisfy a held Booking, flip it to your COMPLETED 成團 pile — it scores its full value, nudges your Tours-Completed meter, and frees a hand slot.
- Cancel it (取消). At your 3-Booking limit and want a new one — or holding a Pot-Luck tour that doesn't fit? Cancel a held Booking into your CANCELLED 取消 pile: a flat −1 at scoring, whatever the tour's value.

Held any-time and night Bookings stay with you across dusk and can still be completed at night.

7. Markets & events

Each region's market holds its foods plus a few events, mostly small hazards. Working a market — a Visit or a Convenience Store — fires any event you flip, at once. A card flipped as you arrive on a Travel does nothing.

- Hazards tax or delay — they never take what you already hold, nor cost a whole turn.
- Boons hand out an ingredient, grow your crowd, or send a stall Trending.

> Who an event hits — read from the region the card came from: ⦿ You · ⬢ This region (everyone there) · ➤ Next door (a neighbour). At a Convenience Store you may be elsewhere, so ⬢ can land on a rival — not an attack, just the island living its day.
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> 排班保養 Scheduled Maintenance (island-wide — its own banner). The HSR is down for everyone: until the start of your next turn, North and South aren't linked — travel the long way round the ring. Then it reopens. (The Globetrotter 阿嬤 is immune.)

8. The day-clock — dusk & the last train

It's one eating day, and the vendors are the clock: the day runs on its stalls, and when the day's stalls are gone the night's begin — when those are gone, it's the last train home. The Booking decks are not the clock (they're just your tour supply); the market decks (ingredients & events) reshuffle and keep coming — only the vendors run out.

- Daytime 白天 — the day's stalls are the 13 daytime vendors. Build your ramp on them.
- 黃昏 DUSK — the moment the day vendors are all gone — claimed or sold out, with none left to put out — dusk falls: finish the current turn, then flip to night. Bring the night vendors and markets online and deal a fresh Booking row from the NIGHT deck. Keep your Larder and Bookings.
- Night Market 夜市 — the 11 nighttime vendors: pricier, fought-over, the ★ apex.
- 末班車 LAST TRAIN — the moment the night vendors are all gone, the last train is called: finish the current round so everyone has had equal turns, then the game ends.

> The Closing-Time die 關門. A stall left too long closes. Track the rounds on the board's little 1·2·3 clock; after round L for your count (2 at 3 players, 3 at 4–6 — the setup chart says which), roll the Closing-Time die and reset the clock. Four faces are regions (北/中/南/東), two are blank (a reprieve). A region face closes that region's oldest face-up stall — even one with a crowd on it: the stall is gone (not reshuffled), and everyone's followers on it go home to their boards, kept — no one loses a contest, the die just called time. A blank, or a rolled region with

no stall to close, does nothing. This is what steadily empties the day pool to dusk and the night pool to the last train.

At each boundary (DUSK and the last train). First break any still-**tied** stall — to **most followers, then earliest committer** (paying if able); losers scatter to their supply. Then followers on **unclaimed** stalls return **home to their boards** — the stall simply closed, unwon. **At DUSK**, any unfinished ☀ **day** tour you still hold is **cancelled** (flat **−1**) — its time is up; your any-time and night tours carry on. **At the last train**, every tour still unfinished in your hand is cancelled the same way (flat **−1** each).

9. Scoring

Total each player once:

- **+ the full value** of every Booking in your **COMPLETED 成團** pile — the tours that ran.
- **−1** for every Booking in your **CANCELLED 取消** pile (a flat one point each, whatever its value); any Booking still unfinished in hand at the last train is cancelled too.

Vendors and Followers score nothing. Most points is **Top Agent**; ties break to most vendors, then most regions covered, then fewest cancelled Bookings.

The six agents

Everyone plays the same game with one twist. Each board states its agent's exact ability and flaw; in short:

- The Old Councillor 里長伯 — name one home region; while there, start each turn drawing 1 ingredient from any market, free (neighbours look after their beloved local); away, it sleeps.
- The Homebody 媽寶 — sole on-the-move sourcer: on a Travel, draw the top 2 of the region you left and keep both (event whiffs).
- The Big Eater 大胃王 — on a Visit, keep all 3 (may grab a 4th, but send 1 follower back to your supply). Flaw: hazards fire twice on his Visit.
- The Influencer 網紅 — a deeper crowd: 8 followers, not 6. Flaw: takes the last seat.
- The Big Brother 大哥 — he wins ties (need only to match the biggest crowd).
- The Globetrotter 阿嬤 — her Travel reaches any region in one action; immune to Scheduled Maintenance. Each trip tires her crowd: 1 follower back to supply.

FAQ

- My board is empty — can I Promote? No — you can only commit followers already on your board. Grow more first; every Travel grows one.

- A rival won a stall my followers were on. They go back to your own supply (never to the rival), to rally again. A bad-review event works the same way.
- A market or Booking deck runs out. Reshuffle a market's discard — ingredients and events never leave the game, they keep coming around. The vendor and Booking decks never reshuffle: the vendors are the clock and must run out (§8); if a Booking deck empties, its face-up row simply stops refilling (you've seen all the tours) — that does not end anything.
- The face-up row has nothing I want. Book Pot-Luck instead (§6): decline the row and draw the top tour off the current deck blind. You keep it — if it doesn't fit, Cancel it later for the flat −1. You are never stuck with no tour worth booking. (If that deck is already empty there's nothing to draw — the row just stops refilling.)
- Can a vendor or a ★ apex stall score? No. Only Bookings score.